Question 3

Inclusive Approach to Software Engineering: a critical evaluation of the class padlet

Common themes. The 45 posts [1] fall into five themes (Figure 1). Most dominant are diverse perspectives (11 posts) and reducing bias (10): a diverse team "increases the chance of things being caught during code review" (P26) [1]. External evidence supports this: facial-analysis systems built on unrepresentative data misclassified darker-skinned women up to 34.7% of the time against 0.8% for lighter-skinned men [2], echoing P41's call for "including different people in datasets" [1]. Business claims (P6, P22) are backed by McKinsey, who found gender-diverse executive teams 39% more likely to outperform financially [3], although this shows correlation, not causation. Contradicting the majority, posts warn diversity helps only "if handled well" (P8) and that "non-diverse teams can fully consider impact" (P35) [1].

Missing and under/over-represented ideas. Generic "more viewpoints" posts are over-represented, often just "More ideas" (P21). Despite the padlet's title, impacts on actual people are thin: disability, gender and income each appear once, while older, neurodivergent and LGBTQ+ users never appear. Costs to businesses appear once (P31), and no post cites evidence or law such as the Equality Act 2010 [4]. As contributors were one class of computing students, the padlet itself may lack diversity.

Critical use of AI. Copilot themed and visualised the posts [5]. As the export splits posts into "Subject" and "Body" with "No data" fillers, we merged these first. Copilot's first output [describe its main error], so we re-prompted it and checked all 45 posts manually (Figure 2). All supporting sources were found independently.

Overall, the padlet explains why diverse teams matter but rarely who is affected, so it is a narrow, largely uncritical starting point.

[INSERT FIGURE 1 HERE: the mind map Copilot produced from the 45 padlet posts, after you have checked and corrected it. Delete this box text and paste the image (Insert > Picture), sized to fill this box]

Figure 1: *Copilot-generated mind map of the 45 padlet posts [1], checked and corrected by us [5].*

"there will almost always be someone who could be affected by the software negatively on the team" – P32 [1]

Figure 2: Checking the AI

Theme (posts in our manual check):

- Diverse perspectives & teamwork – 11
- Reducing bias & improving quality – 10
- Accessibility & understanding users – 9
- Business & society – 8
- Limits & conditions – 7

Copilot's first count: [fill in, e.g. 4 themes, 41 posts].
Corrections made: [e.g. P8, P31 moved]

Who is missing from the padlet?

Posts naming each group (of 45):

- Disabled people – 1 (P3)
- Women / gender – 1 (P12, "a pregnant woman")
- Low-income users – 1 (P18, "digital divide")
- Older users – 0
- Neurodivergent users – 0
- LGBTQ+ users – 0

Over-represented: "more viewpoints / ideas" – 11 posts, many only 1–3 words

Critical or cautious posts: 7 of 45

Posts citing evidence or law: 0 of 45

References (Question 3)

[Merge these into the group's single References page and renumber so citations run in order across Q1–Q3.]

[1] J. Hoey, "Inclusive approach to software engineering: The impacts on people, society, businesses," Padlet, CO3101 Lecture 5, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://padlet.com/jameshoey/cw1q3. [Accessed: [dd Mmm. 2026]].

[2] J. Buolamwini and T. Gebru, "Gender shades: Intersectional accuracy disparities in commercial gender classification," in *Proc. 1st Conf. Fairness, Accountability and Transparency*, PMLR vol. 81, 2018, pp. 77–91.

[3] McKinsey & Company, "Diversity matters even more: The case for holistic impact," Nov. 2023. [Online]. Available: https://www.mckinsey.com/featured-insights/diversity-and-inclusion/diversity-matters-even-more-the-case-for-holistic-impact

[4] *Equality Act 2010*, c. 15. London, U.K.: The Stationery Office, 2010. [Online]. Available: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2010/15/contents

[5] Microsoft Copilot, "Thematic grouping and mind map of CO3101 padlet posts," AI chat, 2026. [Online]. Available: [shared Copilot chat link]. [Accessed: [dd Mmm. 2026]].

[6] Anthropic Claude, "Analysis of padlet posts and drafting of CO3101 CW1 Question 3," AI chat, 2026. [Online]. Available: [shared Claude chat link]. [Accessed: [dd Mmm. 2026]].

AI use declaration

Microsoft Copilot [5] was used to group the padlet posts into themes and produce the mind map in Figure 1; every post was checked manually against the padlet and errors were corrected. Claude [6] was used to independently count the posts per theme, suggest supporting sources and help draft the structure and wording of this answer; all quotes, counts and sources were checked by us against the originals. [Edit to match exactly what you did.]